

“People in the country are fast losing faith in the judiciary.”

JUSTICE A.K. MATHUR AND JUSTICE MARKANDEY KATJU, SUPREME COURT JUDGES



Rule of Law

Widespread incidents of violence on the streets across the country suggest a pan-Indian impatience with the institutions meant to ensure law and order and to dispense justice

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A woman in a clothes store suddenly begins to scream. Someone, she says, has stolen her child's golden anklet. As the staff and other shoppers begin to search for the missing anklet, they notice two women—one of them pregnant, and a child outside the store. The low whisper of suspicion turns into a rumble of accusation and the cry goes up: “It must be them...” Within minutes, the women are surrounded, and angry fists rain down on them, hands ripping and tearing apart clothes and carry bags. The child is terrified, begging for mercy as a crowd of about 100 gathers. Only when the police enter the scene does the mob pause for breath. The women are taken to the police station and

DELHI OCT 7, 2007

A mob goes on a rampage after a city bus kills seven.

BENGAL SEPT 30, 2007

Crowds attack ration shops at Labpur in Birbhum district.

BIHAR SEPT 13, 2007

Ten people lynched in Dhelapurwa village in Vaishali district.

U.P. AUG 28, 2007

A procession in Agra turns violent after a truck kills four.

AP PHOTO